

MATH 74: ALGEBRAIC TOPOLOGY

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1. TOPOLOGICAL SPACES & HOMEOMORPHISMS

Definition 1.1. A **topology** on a set X is a collection J of subsets of X having the following properties.

- (1) $\emptyset, X \in J$
- (2) The union of the elements of any sub-collection of J is in J .
- (3) The intersection of finitely many elements in J is in J .

A set for which a topology has been specified is said to be a topological space. We think of it as a pair (X, J) .

Definition 1.2. Elements of J are called **open sets** of the topological space (X, J) .

Definition 1.3. A subspace Y of a topological space (X, J) is a subset $Y \subset X$ which is given the **subspace topology** where the open sets of $Y = \{U \cap Y : U \in J\}$

Definition 1.4. A space X is **path connected** if every pair of points of X can be joined by a path in X .

Definition 1.5. Let (X_1, J_1) and (X_2, J_2) be topological spaces. A map $f : (X_1, J_1) \rightarrow (X_2, J_2)$ is said to be **continuous** if $f^{-1}(U) \in J_1$ for all $U \in J_2$.

Definition 1.6. Let (X, J) and (X', J') be topological spaces. Then they are **homeomorphic** if $\exists$ a continuous bijection $f : (X, J) \rightarrow (X', J')$. So that f^{-1} is also continuous.

Exercise 1.1. Show that any two open intervals of $\mathbb{R}$ are homeomorphic (where we put subspace topology on the open intervals).

Solution. Let (a, b) and (c, d) be open intervals. **TODO:**

Remark 1.7. Number of path connected topologies is preserved by continuous maps. For instance, $[0, 1]$ is not homeomorphic to $(0, 1)$, and $\mathbb{R}$ is not homeomorphic to $\mathbb{R}^2$.

Exercise 1.2.

- (a) Is $\mathbb{R}^2$ homeomorphic to $\mathbb{R}^3$?
- (b) Is $S^2 (= x^2 + y^2 + z^2 = 1)$ homeomorphic to $T^2 = S^1 \times S^1$?
- (c) Is S^2 homeomorphic to $S^1 \times [a, b]$?

Solution.

- (a) **TODO:**

Definition 1.8. If f and f' are continuous maps from spaces X to Y we say that f is homotopic to f' if $\exists$ a continuous map $F : X \times I = [0, 1] \rightarrow Y$ such that $F(x, 0) = f(x)$ and $F(x, 1) = f'(x)$. F is called the **homotopy** between f and f' , and we write $f \simeq f'$.

Definition 1.9. If X and Y are topological spaces, we can define a **product topology** on $X \times Y$ by saying that a basis consists of the subsets $U \times V$ as U ranges over open sets in X and V ranges over open sets in Y .

Definition 1.10. Define a **path** f as $f : [0, 1] \rightarrow X$ with $f(0) = x_0$ and $f(1) = x$.

Definition 1.11. Two paths $f, f' : [0, 1] \rightarrow X$ are said to be path homotopic if there exist a continuous map $F : I \times I \rightarrow X$ such that $\forall s \in I$,

$$F(s, 0) = f(s), \quad F(s, 1) = f'(s)$$

and $\forall t \in I$,

$$F(0, t) = x_0, \quad F(1, t) = x$$

Then we write $f \underset{p}{\simeq} f'$.

Example 1.1. Let $f : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ and $g : X \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$ then $f \simeq g$.

Proof. Want to find F such that $F : X \times I \rightarrow \mathbb{R}^2$. $F(x, 0) = f(x)$, $F(x, 1) = g(x)$ for all $x \in X$. The following map (straight line homotopy) works.

$$F(x, t) = (1 - t)f(x) + tg(x)$$

□

Lemma 1.12. The relations $\simeq$ and $\simeq_p$ are equivalence relations.

Proof.

- (1) Reflexive: $f \simeq f$ by $F(s, t) = f(s)$.
- (2) Symmetric: Let $f \simeq g$ by the homotopy $F(s, t)$. We can show $g \simeq f$ by $F(w, t) = F(s, 1 - t)$.
- (3) Transitive: Let $f \simeq g$ by $F(s_1, t)$ and $g \simeq h$ by $G(s_2, t)$. We can show that $f \simeq h$ by $H(s, t) = \begin{cases} s = s_1, & 0 \leq t \leq 1/2 \\ s = s_2, & 1/2 \leq t \leq 1 \end{cases}$ **TODO: check and also prove for $\simeq_p$**

Thus path-homotopies are equivalence relations and we write $[f]$ to denote the path-homotopy equivalence class of f . □

Lemma 1.13 (Pasting Lemma). Let $X = A \cup B$ be a topological space with $A, B \subset X$ are closed. Let $f : A \rightarrow Y, g : B \rightarrow Y$ be continuous and $f(x) = g(x), \forall x \in A \cap B$, then

$$h(x) = \begin{cases} f(x), & x \in A \\ g(x), & x \in B \end{cases}$$

is continuous.

Definition 1.14. Let $f : I \rightarrow X$ be a path from x_0 to x_1 and $g : I \rightarrow X$ be a path from x_1 to x_2 , then we define a new path

$$f \star g : I \rightarrow X$$

from x_0 to x_2 by

$$f \star g(t) = \begin{cases} f(2t), & t \in [0, 1/2] \\ g(2t - 1), & t \in [1/2, 1] \end{cases}$$

where $\star$ is **composition of paths**.

Some Properties of ' $\star$ '.

(1) ' $\star$ ' is well-defined operation in the path homotopy equivalence class,

$$[f] \star [g] = [f \star g]$$

(2) Identity:

$$[f] \star [e_{x_1}] = [f], \quad [e_{x_0}] \star [f] = [f]$$

where e_{x_t} is the constant path based at $x \in X$ and $t \in [0, 1]$

(3) Inverse:

$$[f] \star [\bar{f}] = [e_{x_0}], \quad [\bar{f}] \star [f] = [e_{x_1}]$$

where $\bar{f}(t) = f(1 - t)$.

(4) Associative:

$$[f] \star ([g] \star [h]) = ([f] \star [g]) \star [h]$$

Proof.

(1) Let $f \simeq_p f'$ by F and $g \simeq g'$ by G , then we can show that $f \star g \simeq f' \star g'$ by defining $H : I \times I \rightarrow X$ such that

$$H(s, t) = \begin{cases} F(2s, t), & s \in [0, 1/2] \\ G(2s - 1, t), & s \in [1/2, 1] \end{cases}$$

(2) $f \star e_{x_1} \simeq f$ by $H : I \times I \rightarrow X$ such that

$$H(s, t) = \begin{cases} f\left(\frac{2s}{2-t}\right), & s \in [0, \frac{2-t}{2}] \\ x_1, & s \in [\frac{2-t}{2}, 1] \end{cases}$$

(3) $f \star \bar{f} \simeq_p e_{x_0}$.

Define a path $\alpha(t)$ that starts at x_0 and ends at $f(t)$. Then the path-homotopy is given by $\alpha(t) \star \bar{\alpha}(t)$.

$$H(s, t) = \begin{cases} f(2st), & s \in [0, 1/2] \\ f(2t(1 - s)), & s \in [1/2, 1] \end{cases}$$

TODO: straight line homotopy

(4) **TODO:**

□

Remark 1.15. Note that $\star$ operation on the set of path-homotopy equivalence classes of paths in the space X forms a groupoid structure.

2. THE FUNDAMENTAL GROUP

Definition 2.1. Let X be a space and $x_0 \in X$ be a point in X we say that a path $f : I \rightarrow X$ is a **loop** based at x_0 if $f(0) = f(1) = x_0$

Definition 2.2. The set of all path-homotopy equivalence classes of loops based at x_0 forms a group under $\star$ called the **fundamental group** of x based at x_0 , denoted as $\pi_1(X, x_0)$

- Identity: $[e_{x_0}]$
- Inverses: $[f] \rightarrow [\bar{f}]$

Example 2.1. $\pi_1(\mathbb{R}^n, (0, 0)) \equiv 0 \equiv \langle e_{origin} \rangle$

Proof. Take any two loops $f(t), g(t)$ based at the origin. Then consider the straight-line homotopy

$$H(s, t) = f(s)(1 - t) + tg(s)$$

TODO: (Check that it is a path homotopy) □

Definition 2.3. Let α be a path from x_0 to x_1 , where $x_0, x_1 \in X$. We define a map $\hat{\alpha} : \pi_1(X, x_0) \rightarrow \pi_1(X, x_1)$ such that

$$\hat{\alpha}([f]) := [\bar{\alpha}] \star [f] \star [\alpha] = [\bar{\alpha} \star f \star \alpha]$$

Proposition 2.4. $\hat{\alpha}$ is well-defined and an isomorphism.

Proof. Let $f \simeq_p f'$. We need to check that

$$\begin{aligned} [\bar{\alpha}] \star [f] \star [\alpha] &= [\bar{\alpha}] \star [f'] \star [\alpha] \\ \iff [\bar{\alpha} \star f \star \alpha] &= [\bar{\alpha} \star f' \star \alpha] \\ \iff \bar{\alpha} \star f \star \alpha &\simeq_p \bar{\alpha} \star f' \star \alpha \end{aligned}$$

Since $\star$ is well-defined, $[f] \star [\alpha] = [f'] \star [\alpha]$, $\hat{\alpha}$ is well-defined

Let $[f], [g] \in \pi_1(X, x_0)$.

$$\begin{aligned} \hat{\alpha}([f]) \star \hat{\alpha}([g]) &= [\bar{\alpha}] \star [f] \star [\alpha] \star [\bar{\alpha}] \star [g] \star [\alpha] \\ &= [\bar{\alpha}] \star [f] \star [e_{x_0}] \star [g] \star [\alpha] \\ &= [\bar{\alpha}] \star [f] \star [g] \star [\alpha] \\ &= \hat{\alpha}([f] \star [g]) \end{aligned}$$

Hence $\hat{\alpha}$ is a homomorphism. To check that $\hat{\alpha}$ is an isomorphism, we see that $\hat{\hat{\alpha}}(\hat{\alpha})([f]) = [f]$ for all $[f] \in \pi_1(X, x_0)$. □

Corollary 2.4.1. The fundamental group of X based at x_0 only depends on the path-connected component of $x_0 \in X$ upto isomorphism.

Definition 2.5. Let $h : X \rightarrow Y$ be a continuous map such that $h(x_0) = y_0$, $x_0 \in X, y_0 \in Y$. Then define $h_\star : \pi_1(X, x_0) \rightarrow \pi_1(Y, y_0)$ by $h_\star([f]) = [h \circ f]$. This is a **push-forward** map.

Proposition 2.6. $h_\star$ is a well-defined homomorphism.

Proof. Let $f \simeq_p f'$. We need to check that $h \circ f \simeq_p h \circ f'$. Let $H : I \times I \rightarrow X$ be the path homotopy between f and f' . Consider $h \circ H : I \times I \rightarrow Y$.

$$\begin{aligned} h \circ H(s, 0) &= h \circ f \\ h \circ H(s, 1) &= h \circ f' \\ h \circ H(0, t) &= h \circ f(0) \\ h \circ H(1, t) &= h \circ f(1) = h \circ f(0) \end{aligned}$$

Hence $h \circ H$ is the required path-homotopy.

Consider $[f], [g] \in \pi_1(X, x_0)$. We want to show that $h_*([f]) \star h_*([g]) = h_*([f] \star [g])$.

$$h_*([f]) \star h_*([g]) = [h \circ f] \star [h \circ g]$$

Note that it suffices to show that $h(f \star g) = (h \circ f) \star (h \circ g)$. Now,

$$\begin{aligned} h(f \star g)(s) &= \begin{cases} (h \circ f)(2s), & s \in [0, \frac{1}{2}] \\ (h \circ g)(2s - 1), & s \in [\frac{1}{2}, 1] \end{cases} \\ &= (h \circ f) \star (h \circ g) \end{aligned}$$

Hence proved. □

Theorem 2.7. If $h : (X, x_0) \rightarrow (Y, y_0)$ and $k : (Y, y_0) \rightarrow (Z, z_0)$ then

- (a) $(k \circ h)_* = k_* \circ h_*$
- (b) If $\text{id} : (X, x_0) \rightarrow (X, x_0)$ is the identity map then $(\text{id})_*$ is the identity $\pi_1(X, x_0) \rightarrow \pi_1(X, x_0)$.

Proof. (a)

$$\begin{aligned} (k \circ h)_*([f]) &= [(k \circ h) \circ f] \\ &= [k(h(f))] \\ &= [k_*([h_*([f])])] \\ &= (k_* \circ h_*)[f] \end{aligned}$$

$$(b) \quad (\text{id})_*[f] = [\text{id} \circ f] = [f]$$

□

Corollary 2.7.1. If $h : X \rightarrow Y$ is a homeomorphism then $\pi(X, x_0) \cong \pi(Y, h(x_0))$ via h_* .

Definition 2.8. Let $P : E \rightarrow B$ be a surjective map. A open set $U \subseteq B$ is said to be **evenly covered** by P if $P^{-1}(U) = \bigsqcup_{\alpha} V_{\alpha}$, where V_{α} are open sets of E for all α and $P|_{V_{\alpha}}$ is a homeomorphism of V_{α} onto U .

Definition 2.9. Let $P : E \rightarrow B$ be surjective if every point $b \in B$ has a neighbourhood $U \subset B$ such that U is evenly covered by P . Then we say that P is a **covering map** and E is a **covering space** of B .

Example 2.2.

(1) $\text{id} : X \rightarrow X$.

(2) $X \times \{1, 2, \dots, n\} \xrightarrow{P} X$ where $P(X, i) = x$.

Theorem 2.10. The map $P : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow S'$ such that $x \mapsto (\cos(2\pi x), \sin(2\pi x))$ is a covering space.

Proof. $P^{-1}(U) = \bigsqcup_{n \in \mathbb{Z}} (n - \frac{1}{4}, n + \frac{1}{4}) =: V_n$

Restricted to each V_n the map P is a homeomorphism because $\sin(2\pi x)$ is strictly monotonic on V_n for all n .

TODO: finish □

Definition 2.11. If a path-connected space X has $\pi_1(X, x_0) \cong 0$ then we say that X is **simply-connected**.

Lemma 2.12. If X is simply-connected, then any two paths in X with the same initial point and end point are path-homotopic.

Proof. $f \star \bar{g} \simeq_p e_{x_0}$ and $f \simeq_p f \star e_{x_1} \simeq_p f \star (\bar{g} \star g) \simeq_p (f \star \bar{g}) \star g \simeq_p e_{x_0} \star g \simeq_p g$. □

Definition 2.13. Let $p : E \rightarrow B$ be a surjective map, $f : X \rightarrow B$ be a map from $X \rightarrow B$. Then a map $\tilde{f} : X \rightarrow E$ is called **lifting** of f to E if $p \circ \tilde{f} = f$.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & E & \\ & \downarrow p & \\ X & \xrightarrow{\tilde{f}} & B \\ & \xrightarrow{f} & \end{array}$$

Lemma 2.14 (Path Lifting Lemma). Let $p : E \rightarrow B$ be a covering map with $p(e_0) = b_0$. Any path $f : [0, 1] \rightarrow B$ beginning at b_0 can be lifted uniquely to a path $\tilde{f} : [0, 1] \rightarrow E$ beginning at e_0 .

Proof. Cover B by open sets U , each of which is evenly covered by p . We can find a subdivision (partition) defined by $s_0, \dots, s_n \in [0, 1]$ such that $f([s_i, s_{i+1}])$ is contained entirely inside a evenly covered U for all i . **TODO: Think about why this is possible.** Now we will define $\tilde{f}$ inductively. Suppose that $\tilde{f}(0) = e_0$ and it has been defined for $0 \leq s \leq s_i$ for some i . We will now define $\tilde{f}$ at $[s_i, s_{i+1}]$. Suppose that $f([s_i, s_{i+1}]) \subset U$ where U is evenly covered open set of B . This implies that $p^{-1}(U) = \bigsqcup_{\alpha} V_{\alpha}$. Now, $\tilde{f}(s_i)$ lies in one such V_{α} say V_0 .

Define $\tilde{f}$ on $[s_i, s_{i+1}]$ as $\tilde{f}(s) := (p|_{V_0})^{-1}(f(s))$ for all $s \in [s_i, s_{i+1}]$. By pasting lemma $\tilde{f}$ is continuous on $[0, s_{i+1}]$ and we argue inductively to define $\tilde{f}$ for $[0, 1]$.

By induction, we can again suppose that for another lift $\tilde{f}' : [0, 1] \rightarrow E$ of f with $\tilde{f}'(0) = e_0$, it agrees with $\tilde{f}$ of $0 \leq s \leq s_i$ for some i

$$\tilde{f}'(s) = \tilde{f}(s), \quad \forall s \in [0, s_i]$$

Now we would like to show that

$$\tilde{f}'(s) = \tilde{f}(s), \quad \forall s \in [s_i, s_{i+1}]$$

$$\tilde{f}'(s) = (p|_{V_0})^{-1} \circ f(s), \quad \forall s \in [s_i, s_{i+1}]$$

$\tilde{f}'(s_i)$ lies in V_0 since $\tilde{f}'(s_i) = \tilde{f}(s_i) \implies \tilde{f}'([s_i, s_{i+1}])$ lies in V_0 .

$p \circ \tilde{f}' = f$ on $[s_i, s_{i+1}]$. But $\tilde{f}'([s_i, s_{i+1}]) \subset V_0$ and $p|_{V_0}$ is a homeomorphism.

Then for all $s \in [s_i, s_{i+1}]$

$$\implies \tilde{f}'(s) = (p|_{V_0})^{-1} \circ f(s) = \tilde{f}(s)$$

□

Lemma 2.15 (Path Homotopy Lifting Lemma). *Let $p : E \rightarrow B$ be a covering map. Let $p(e_0) = b_0$. Let $f : I \times I \rightarrow B$ be a map, with $f(0, 0) = b_0$. Then there exists a lifting of f to E such that $\tilde{f}(0, 0) = e_0$. If f is a path homotopy, so is $\tilde{f}$.*

Proof. **TODO:** $I \times I$ is a rectangle. Pick a partition of both sides, then the image of these small rectangles will be contained in U

1. Define $\tilde{f}$ on $0 \times I$ and $I \times 0$ by lifting both of those paths to paths that begin at e_0 .
2. Take a subdivision of $I \times I$ say $I_i \times J_j$ such that each of those small rectangles are contained in an evenly covered open set of B .
3. By induction assume that $\tilde{f}$ has been defined on $I_i \times J_j$ such that $i < i_0, j = j_0$.
4. Now, to define $\tilde{f}$ on $I_{i_0} \times I_{j_0}$ we consider the image of the union of left and bottom edge of $I_{i_0} \times I_{j_0}$ under $\tilde{f}$. This lies inside $V_0 \subset p^{-1}(U)$. □

Remark 2.16. *The lifted path homomoty is also unique.*

Lemma 2.17. *Let $P : E \rightarrow B$ be a covering map with $P(e_0) = b_0$. Let f, g be two paths in B from b_0 to b_1 . Let $\tilde{f}, \tilde{g}$ be their lifts beginning at e_0 . Then if $f \simeq_p g \implies \tilde{f}$ and $\tilde{g}$ end at the same point and they are path homotopic.*

Proof. Assume $f \simeq_p g$ with the path homotopy $F : I \times I \rightarrow B$. Then Lemma 2.15 implies that F lifts to $\tilde{F} : I \times I \rightarrow E$ with $\tilde{F}(0, t) = e_0$.

Then we can say that $\tilde{F}(1, t) = e_1$ for some $e_1 \in P^{-1}(b_1)$, $\forall t \in I$. By uniqueness of path lifting, f, g have unique lifts to E , beginning at e_0 . We also know that $\tilde{F}(s, 0)$ and $\tilde{F}(s, 1)$ are lifts of f, g both beginning at e_0 .

Then $\tilde{F}(s, 0) = \tilde{f}$ and $\tilde{F}(s, 1) = \tilde{g}$ for all $s \in I$. Hence $\tilde{F}(1, 0) = \tilde{F}(1, 1) \implies \tilde{f}(1) = \tilde{g}(1)$, and $\tilde{f} \simeq \tilde{g}$. □

Theorem 2.18. $\pi_1(S^1, (1, 0) = b_0) \cong (\mathbb{Z}, +)$

Proof.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & & \mathbb{R} \\ & \nearrow \tilde{f} & \downarrow \\ I & \xrightarrow{f} & S^1 \end{array}$$

Consider the covering map

$$P : \mathbb{R} \rightarrow S^1, P(x) = (\cos(2\pi x), \sin(2\pi x))$$

Let $[f] \in \pi_1(S^1, b_0)$. Let $\tilde{f}$ be the lift of f to $\mathbb{R}$ beginning at 0. Now consider $\tilde{f}(1)$. It will be an integer since $\tilde{f}(1) \in P^{-1}(b_0) = P^{-1}((1, 0))$. Define

$$\phi : \pi_1(S^1, b_0) \rightarrow \mathbb{Z}, \quad \phi([f]) = f(1)$$

By previous lemma, ϕ is well-defined.

Now we show that ϕ is surjective. Let $n \in \mathbb{Z}$. Define $\tilde{f}$ to be the path in $\mathbb{R}$ which starts at 0 and ends at n . Then by definition, $(P \circ \tilde{f})$ will start at $(1, 0)$ and end at $(1, 0)$ where $\tilde{f}$ is by definition the lift of $(P \circ \tilde{f})$ beginning at 0. So $\phi([P \circ \tilde{f}]) = n$.

To show that ϕ is injective suppose that $\phi([f]) = \phi([g]) = n$ for some $[f], [g] \in \pi_1(S^1, b_0)$ we need to show that $[f] = [g] \in \pi_1(S^1, b_0)$.

Now let $\tilde{f}$ and $\tilde{g}$ be two lifts of f and g respectively beginning at 0. Moreover, since $\mathbb{R}$ is simply connected and $\tilde{f}(0) = \tilde{g}(0) = 0$, $\tilde{f}(1) = \tilde{g}(1) = n$, $\tilde{f} \simeq_p \tilde{g}$, then $P \circ \tilde{f}$ will be the path-homotopy between f and g . This implies $[f] = [g]$.

Now we want to show that ϕ is a group homomorphism. Let $[f], [g] \in \pi_1(S^1, b_0)$ such that $\phi([f]) = n$, $\phi([g]) = m$ for $n, m \in \mathbb{Z}$. Now we want to show that $\phi([f] \star [g]) = \phi([f \star g]) = n + m$. We need to find a lift of $f \star g$ beginning at 0 and ending at $n + m$.

Let $\tilde{f}, \tilde{g}$ be lifts of f, g respectively, $\tilde{f}(0) = \tilde{g}(0) = (0)$.

Define a path on $\mathbb{R}$ by

$$h(s) = \begin{cases} \tilde{f}(2s), & s \in [0, \frac{1}{2}] \\ n + \tilde{g}(2s - 1), & s \in [\frac{1}{2}, 1] \end{cases}$$

Then h is a path beginning at 0 and ending at $n + m$. Now consider,

$$P(h(s)) = \begin{cases} P \circ \tilde{f}(2s), & s \in [0, \frac{1}{2}] \\ P \circ (n + \tilde{g}(2s - 1)) = P \circ \tilde{g}(2s - 1), & s \in [\frac{1}{2}, 1] \end{cases}$$

This implies that $h(s)$ is a lift of $f \star g(s) \implies \phi([f \star g]) = h(1) = n + m$ □

Corollary 2.18.1. *Fundamental Theorem of Algebra.*

Proof. Let $p(z) = z^n + a_1 z^{n-1} + \dots + a_n$, where $a_i \in \mathbb{C}$.

For the sake of contradiction assume that p has no roots in $\mathbb{C}$. Then for each $r \in \mathbb{R}^+$ define a function

$$f_r(s) = \frac{\frac{p(re^{2\pi is})}{p(r)}}{\left| \frac{p(re^{2\pi is})}{p(r)} \right|} \in \mathbb{C}$$

Note that $f_r(s)$ is a loop in S^1 based at $(1, 0)$ for all r . ($f_r(0) = (1, 0) = f_r(1)$ and $|f_r(s)| = 1, \forall s$). Note that as r varies f_r gives a path homotopy in S^1 between loops that are based at $(1, 0)$. Now, note that $f_0(s)$ is the trivial loop based at $(1, 0)$. This implies,

$$[f_r(s)] = [f_0(s)] = 0 \in \pi_1(S^1, (1, 0))$$

Now fix a large value of r such that $r > |a_1| + \dots + |a_n|$ and $r > 1$. Now, we have for $|z| = r$

$$|z^n| = |z| \cdot |z^{n-1}| > (a_1 z^{n-1} + \dots + a_n) |z^{n-1}| \geq |a_1 z^{n-1}| + \dots + |a_n| \geq |a_1 z^{n-1} + \dots + a_n|$$

Hence,

$$|z^n| > |a_1 z^{n-1} + \dots + a_n|$$

This implies that the polynomial $p_t(z) = z^n + t(a_1 z^{n-1} + \dots + a_n)$, $\forall t \in [0, 1]$ has no roots in circle $|z| = r$. If we now replace p by p_t in the definition of $f_r(s)$ we get

$$f_r(s, t) = \frac{\frac{p_t(re^{2\pi is})}{p_t(r)}}{\left| \frac{p_t(re^{2\pi is})}{p_t(r)} \right|}$$

At $t = 1$,

$$f_r(s, 1) = f_r(s) \in \pi_1(S^1, (1, 0))$$

At $t = 0$,

$$f_r(s, 0) = e^{2\pi i s}, \quad \forall s \in [0, 1]$$

So $[f_r(s, 0)] = n \in \mathbb{Z} \cong \pi_1(S^1, (1, 0))$. But $f_r(s, t)$ as we vary $t \in [0, 1]$ gives a path homotopy between $f_r(s, 0)$ and $f_r(s, 1) \implies [f_r(s, 0)] = [f_r(s)] \in \pi_1(S^1, (1, 0)) \implies n = 0$ contradicting that p is not constant. $\square$

Remark 2.19. In general, we have $P : (E, e_0) \rightarrow (B, b_0)$ be a covering map. If E is path-connected then there exists a surjection $\phi : \pi_1(B, b_0) \rightarrow P^{-1}(b_0)$. If E is simply-connected, then ϕ is a bijection.

Proof. HW1 iirc $\square$